

A FREE EBOOK

PIRATE WISDOM

100 Lines from the Seven Seas

Old pirates. New wisdom.

@piratewisdom

A Word Before Ye Sail

These hundred lines were gathered from taverns, crow's nests, and storm-tossed decks across the seven seas. No line longer than a breath, no wisdom that needs a map to find. Read one each morning, and sail a little steadier than ye did yesterday.

Contents

1. Set Sail

Courage & action 4

2. Weathering the Storm

Resilience & adversity 6

3. The Captain's Mind

Discipline & focus 8

4. Gold & Greed

Wealth & what matters 9

5. Crew & Loyalty

The people beside ye 10

6. The Long Voyage

Patience & persistence 12

7. Mind Yer Words

Honesty & character 13

8. Rum & Laughter

Humor for hard days 15

9. Know Thyself

Wisdom & self-mastery 16

CHAPTER ONE

Set Sail

Courage & action

- 1 *Skilled pirates aren't made on smooth seas, matey.*
- 10 *Ships are safe in harbor, matey. But that's not what they're for.*
- 25 *The fastest ship goes nowhere 'til someone raises the sails.*
- 36 *Fear is just excitement without its sea legs.*
- 43 *The ocean rewards the bold and drowns the hesitant.*
- 48 *New lands don't come to those clingin' to the shore.*
- 65 *The plank is shorter for those who hesitate.*
- 81 *Courage isn't the absence of fear. It's fear with its sea legs on.*
- 88 *When the wind dies, row. When the oars break, swim. Never drift.*

CHAPTER TWO

Weathering the Storm

Resilience & adversity

- 7 *Fix the leak yesterday. Second best time? Before we sink.*
- 11 *Don't argue with the wind. Fill yer sails and move on.*
- 18 *The sea doesn't care about yer plans. Sail anyway.*
- 26 *Barnacles don't sink ships. Neglect does.*
- 29 *A storm reveals what calm seas conceal.*
- 31 *Can't control the wind, savvy? Then adjust yer sails.*
- 45 *Mend yer nets in calm weather. Ye'll eat in the storm.*
- 50 *Forget the size of the wave. Steady yer hand.*
- 52 *No one ever regretted learnin' to swim before the storm.*
- 54 *The kraken only grabs those who stop rowing.*

- 57 *Don't let a bad tide ruin a good voyage.*
- 59 *Luck favors the prepared, matey. Sharpen yer sword.*
- 67 *Build yer ship before ye need it.*
- 95 *The sea tests every sailor. The wise ones study for it.*
- 97 *Ignore a small leak and ye'll learn to swim.*

CHAPTER THREE

The Captain's Mind

Discipline & focus

- 14 *Ye don't need a bigger boat. Ye need a better reason to sail.*
- 33 *Chase two ships, catch neither. Pick one, matey.*
- 34 *Scrub yer own deck before judgin' another's.*
- 62 *Excuses are like seagulls. Everyone's got 'em and they all stink.*
- 70 *Don't mistake motion for progress. Even a whirlpool moves fast.*
- 73 *Ambition without discipline is just a fancy way to drown.*
- 86 *A sharp blade and a sharper wit. Never leave port without both.*
- 90 *Choose yer battles like ye choose yer crew. Carefully.*
- 93 *Messy cabin, messy mind, lost map. In that order.*

CHAPTER FOUR

Gold & Greed

Wealth & what matters

- 9 *Count yer doubloons twice and yer friends once.*
- 13 *Gold loses its shine. A good crew doesn't.*
- 20 *Shiny doubloons attract pirates. Shiny character keeps 'em.*
- 23 *Never split the loot before ye count the crew.*
- 32 *Gold in the chest beats promises in the air.*
- 58 *The richest pirate is the one who needs the least.*
- 68 *A pirate's word is worth more than gold. Guard it like treasure.*
- 87 *The greatest treasures aren't buried. They're just overlooked.*

CHAPTER FIVE

Crew & Loyalty

The people beside ye

- 19 *A crew that laughs together plunders together.*
- 28 *Drink with yer crew. Think with yer captain's hat on.*
- 37 *Never argue with the cook. Ye'll lose, and ye'll still be hungry.*
- 44 *A secret shared with the whole crew ain't a secret. It's a sea shanty.*
- 51 *Trust is earned in drops and lost in buckets.*
- 63 *A calm captain in a storm is worth ten cannons.*
- 72 *Keep yer friends close and yer lifeboats closer.*
- 75 *The right joke has saved more crews than cannons.*
- 76 *Never underestimate the quiet one mending nets in the corner.*

- 77 *The crew matters more than the flag they fly.*
- 80 *Share the map, find the bigger island.*
- 83 *A full belly makes a brave pirate. Feed yer crew first.*

CHAPTER SIX

The Long Voyage

Patience & persistence

- 8 *The mighty kraken started as a tiny squid with big dreams.*
- 27 *Every legend was a sailor who refused to turn back.*
- 30 *The map is not the treasure. The voyage is.*
- 41 *Yer past is only an anchor if ye let it drag.*
- 47 *Patience, matey. Even tides turn on schedule.*
- 71 *Every great navigator was once lost. Repeatedly.*
- 74 *Davy Jones started at the bottom too.*
- 79 *Fortune turns as fast as the weather. Stay ready.*
- 84 *The tide waits for no one. But it always comes back.*
- 92 *Legends aren't born. They're just too stubborn to sink.*

CHAPTER SEVEN

Mind Yer Words

Honesty & character

- 2 *Dead men tell no tales, but live ones never shut up about themselves.*
- 4 *The loudest parrot knows the least about navigation.*
- 6 *Never trust a calm sea or a sailor who says 'trust me.'*
- 16 *A parrot repeats what it hears. A pirate means what he says.*
- 21 *Ye can patch a sail in a storm. Yer reputation at the tavern? Never.*
- 24 *The compass says north. Yer gut says somewhere better.*
- 46 *The loudest cannon often fires the emptiest shot.*
- 49 *A grudge is a leaky barrel. It empties ye before it empties them.*
- 55 *Speak softly and carry a big cutlass.*

CHAPTER EIGHT

Rum & Laughter

Humor for hard days

- 5 *A pirate's treasure map is just a to-do list with better drawings.*
- 35 *Aye, the early bird gets the worm. The second mouse gets the cheese.*
- 40 *Know when to fight, when to flee, and when to feign a nap.*
- 42 *Don't count yer chickens before they mutiny.*
- 53 *A full moon and an empty flask make for poor decisions.*
- 60 *Never tattoo a treasure map on someone who sunburns.*
- 66 *Rum solves nothin', but it makes the unsolvable more entertainin'.*
- 91 *The night is darkest just before the rum runs out.*
- 94 *Never play dice with a man who owns the tavern.*

CHAPTER NINE

Know Thyself

Wisdom & self-mastery

- 3 *Ye can't steal second base while keepin' one foot on first.*
- 12 *"This could be run better" -- that's how every mutiny starts.*
- 15 *The captain who won't admit he's lost discovers the most water.*
- 17 *Don't burn the map just because ye don't like where X marks the spot.*
- 22 *Pirates and merchants differ only in who writes the history.*
- 38 *The best revenge is a hold full of treasure and a clear conscience.*
- 39 *The heaviest chains are the ones ye forge yerself.*
- 56 *Yesterday's mutiny is today's leadership lesson.*
- 61 *Everyone sees the same horizon. What ye sail toward is the difference.*

- 64 *Ye find what ye look for. Most pirates look for trouble.*
- 69 *The sea gives, the sea takes, the sea doesn't explain itself.*
- 78 *Regret is the heaviest cargo. Throw it overboard.*
- 82 *Don't sail someone else's course and wonder why ye never arrive.*
- 85 *Worry is interest paid on trouble that hasn't boarded yet.*
- 96 *Home is just the port ye keep sailin' back to.*
- 100 *Gold fades. Stories don't. Make good ones, matey.*

LIKED WHAT YE READ?

Follow @piratewisdom

for daily reels

A fresh line of pirate wisdom every single day -- on Instagram and YouTube. Free forever, no strings, no plank-walking required.

© 2026 Pirate Wisdom